MY STARTING SUGGESTION · FOR THE TEAM TO REACT TO

Two Species, Not Seven

How I'd suggest we scope Project Platypus — open to your input

How I'll explain it — 3 simple steps

1. **The point of the project.** We're building one system that lets a species have an evidence-based voice in policy. To prove it works, we don't need lots of species — we need to show it works across **different data situations**.
2. **So I'd suggest two species.** The **right whale** — loads of data, plus a real policy fight happening now (NOAA deciding whether to scrap ship speed limits). And one **data-poor species** — a bee or mussel, where there's barely any data. Same system, both species, and it's **honest about how confident it can be in each**. That contrast IS our argument.
3. **Not everyone needs their own species.** Two of us own the two species; the rest build the framework around them — the data pipeline, the ethics side, how it plugs into real policy. That's how we go **deep instead of spreading thin**.

The two species at a glance

Right whale — data-RICH

~384 left, ~70 breeding females. Live NOAA policy decision. High-confidence, evidence-backed voice.

Bee / mussel — data-POOR

Barely any data. System flags LOW confidence honestly instead of faking it. Proves the method scales.

Then I hand it over — what I'll actually ask

> **SAY SOMETHING LIKE**
>
> "That's just my starting suggestion to save us time — I might be wrong. What I actually want to know is your view."

Questions for the team:

- Does the **two-species approach** make sense, or do you think we need more?
- Does the **whale** feel like the right hero — or does someone have a stronger idea?
- Bee **or** mussel for the data-poor one — any preference?

Getting real input (not just nods): after you ask, stop talking and let the silence sit. If no one jumps in, go around by name — "P3, what's your instinct?" Direct questions get real answers; open ones get nods. · **Name the trade-off:** "More species looks impressive but risks being shallow; two goes deeper but the contrast has to be strong. Which way do we lean?"